Alexander Dovnar

Chief Technology Officer · Cloud & Platform Engineering

alex@alex-dovnar.in · linkedin.com/in/dovnaralex · alex-dovnar.in · Minsk, Belarus · Remote

SUMMARY

CTO of Naviteq, a DevOps and cloud services company with 50+ engineers and 20+ active clients on Amazon Web Services (AWS) and Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI). Own technology direction, technical pre-sales and solution architecture, the AWS and Oracle partner programs, staffing and hiring, and engineering standards; the Head of DevOps reports to me. Designed the company's management layer and engineer levels framework, built its internal delivery platform, and brought AI tooling into pre-sales and operations. 15 years in infrastructure, from network engineering to cloud architecture, and still hands-on. Co-author of "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025), Kubestronaut, AWS Community Builder, co-host of the DevOps Kitchen Talks podcast.

SKILLS

Leadership: technology strategy, engineering management, organizational design, technical hiring, budgeting, KPIs

Commercial: technical pre-sales, solution architecture, estimations and SOWs, AWS and Oracle partner programs

Cloud & Platform: AWS (expert), OCI, Azure, GCP; cloud migration, platform engineering, FinOps

Engineering: Kubernetes, Terraform / OpenTofu, Terragrunt, Helm, Argo CD / GitOps, GitHub Actions, observability (Prometheus, VictoriaMetrics, Grafana, OpenTelemetry), Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

AI: AI adoption in delivery and pre-sales, AI agents, Model Context Protocol (MCP)

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer — Naviteq Ltd

Feb 2026 – Present

- Lead technology for a DevOps services company with 50+ engineers and 20+ active clients across AWS, OCI and Azure; the Head of DevOps and 7 team leads report through me.
- Run technical pre-sales: discovery calls, high-level designs and estimations for migrations, platform builds and assessments. Redesigned the estimation and SOW format and built a reusable house estimation template.
- Own the AWS partner relationship: leading the push to the Advanced tier, built the co-sell opportunity pipeline and prepared AWS proof-of-concept funding requests.
- Technical lead for Oracle-funded AWS-to-OCI migrations for fintech, AI and cybersecurity clients; an OCI assessment for an ad-tech client cut projected non-production spend by 55%.
- Designed the management layer (delivery and resource-management roles, pods of 6–8 engineers, company-wide ownership map) and the engineer levels framework; own technical hiring and staffing.
- Built Runestra, the company's DevOps accelerator, as sole developer, then grew it into a two-engineer product: 62 Terraform/OpenTofu modules, 42 hardened Helm charts and 34 reusable CI workflows; new client environments go live in under an hour instead of 4–8 weeks.
- Product owner for an AI incident-triage agent and an internal library of AI agent skills for estimations, partner paperwork and code review.
- Authored the company's 60-page engineering standards catalog.

DevOps Team Lead — Naviteq Ltd

Jan 2023 – Jan 2026

- Led a team of DevOps engineers and acted as tech lead on the company's key accounts, from architecture to production, across fintech, ad-tech, security and SaaS.

- Global cybersecurity vendor (SASE platform): architecture and code review; designed the observability migration from Prometheus to VictoriaMetrics for ~20,000 gateways across ~60 regions.
- Built a cloud-agnostic Kubernetes platform for a security startup later acquired by GitLab; raised EKS node utilization from ~70% to 90%+ with Karpenter.
- Created and ran the internal tech-talk program (23 sessions) and replaced a multi-day take-home assignment with a one-hour live technical interview.

Senior DevOps Engineer — Naviteq Ltd
Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

- One of the company's first engineers; delivered client projects end-to-end and cut AWS costs by up to 40%.
- Standardized reusable Terraform/Terragrunt templates and CI/CD pipelines across teams.

Senior DevOps Engineer — OneSoil
Aug 2021 – May 2022 (consulting)

- Designed a multi-account AWS architecture and built the Kubernetes platform; reduced cloud costs by ~30% with no loss of performance.

Lead System Engineer — EPAM Systems
Apr 2016 – Aug 2021

- Grew from junior to lead engineer; as tech lead, planned work, assigned tasks and reviewed solutions for the team.
- Designed and automated AWS infrastructure (Terraform, Ansible) and migrated enterprise systems to AWS and Azure for international fintech and retail clients.

Senior Network Engineer — RUE Beltelecom
Mar 2011 – Apr 2016

- Backbone and enterprise networks for the national telecom operator; automated equipment maintenance.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Kubestronaut (CNCF, 2025): all five Kubernetes certifications active (CKA, CKS, CKAD, KCNA, KCSA)
- Earlier: AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2023–2026), AWS Certified Security – Specialty (2022–2025), HashiCorp Terraform Associate, Cisco CCNA

COMMUNITY & PUBLIC ACTIVITY

- Co-author, "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025, 560 pages; with Viktor Vedmich and Viktoria Semaan)
- Co-organizer and speaker, DKT Conf 2026 (75 attendees on site, 200+ online, registration full within 3 days with no paid ads)
- Speaker: DevOpsDays Kazakhstan 2024 (talk and workshop), AWS Community Day Almaty 2025 (EKS cost-optimization workshop)
- DevOps Kitchen Talks — co-host (2020–present); 100+ episodes, 300k+ views
- AWS Community Builder (2023–present); Terragrunt Ambassador (2025–present)
- Slurm.io — course author and trainer (Kubernetes, CI/CD, Terraform), including a corporate Kubernetes program for a major bank

LANGUAGES

- English (fluent), Russian (native)

EDUCATION

- Engineer's degree, Belarusian State University of Informatics and Radioelectronics (BSUIR), 2015